

User Evaluation Report

Group Number: Cohort 1, Group 11

Group Name: Y111 Studios

Group Members:

1. James Hutchinson
2. Somto Igweonu
3. Robert Kisloski
4. Sam Knight
5. Kenneth Kok
6. Ashish Kumar

This document outlines our approach to conducting the task-based user evaluation of a prototype of our game, including the methods employed in the recruitment and data collection processes, and a tabular presentation of the usability issues identified.

Purpose & Scope of the Evaluation

We want to have our system play-tested by potential end users, to gain insight into what changes we can make to improve the final product. It would be better to obtain this insight from potential users instead of play-testing the game ourselves, as we are already familiar with the game and have designed it based on our own interpretation of the product brief; it would be more appropriate to gain opinions from people outside our group to explore different perspectives and design possibilities that we have not yet considered.

We are conducting task-based user evaluation, which is advantageous since it provides more realistic testing by focusing on tasks that users will actually perform in real-world conditions, and so it will allow us to measure how well the software supports user goals and workflows. This type of evaluation also allows for objective measurement, since metrics such as task completion time, errors, and satisfaction will help quantify usability and track improvements over time.

Evaluation Methods

We will adopt an opportunity sampling technique to recruit our participants, where we will contact our friends and family, and other members of the cohort. This type of recruitment is quick and easy, and it will allow us to gather participants that will match the intended target audience of the game.

We have decided to recruit at least three participants, as we believe that this is an appropriate number of users to provide us with enough constructive feedback to allow us to improve our product. We will send an Information Sheet and a Consent Form via email to be read and filled in before the session. These will provide details about our project and the evaluation sessions, and will allow participants to indicate their consent to taking part in the project. We will collect the name of each participant to keep track of participant consent, and their age and gender so that we can describe our sample. All data will be anonymised in accordance with our ethical guidelines.

The sessions will be in-person, online or a mixture of both, thus providing flexibility as it will provide participants with more options to choose from, so that they can take part in the way that they find most convenient. Each session will be at most 30 minutes, so sessions will not be too elaborate but there will still be enough time to gather valuable feedback. Each session will involve an evaluator to facilitate the session and guide the user, and an observer to take notes and collect the required data.

We will collect the success rates and completion time of each task to assess the difficulty of our game. We will note down the usability issues encountered, to evaluate which features need to be worked on to improve the functionality of the game. We will also ask the user to rate their satisfaction with each task and provide comments in order to get hints into what features they would like us to improve.

Evaluation Results

The table below summarises the results collected from our user evaluation sessions. It shows the average completion time and user satisfaction for each task, and provides a list of usability issues identified, if any, for each of the tasks.

Task ID	Task Description	Success Rate (%)	Time to Complete (s)	Usability Issues	User Satisfaction (1-5)	Comments / Feedback
T1	Place at least one of each of the building types.	100%	20.3 s	None	4.3	The building menu design could be improved. There were very few options to choose from for each type of building.
T2	Build a fully functional campus - balance functional buildings while ensuring everything is in a reasonable proximity to one another.	100%	117.3 s	No indication for how much each of the buildings cost. Proximity of important buildings to each other does not affect the student satisfaction.	3.3	It would be helpful to add an indication for how much each of the buildings costs, and an indication of the building capacities. The game would be more engaging if there was the added challenge of having to manage the proximity of important buildings to each other.
T3	React to a random event - make decisions, such as moving or building new structures.	100%	51.7 s	None	3.3	This event system was not really challenging to deal with; dynamic events could be more engaging. An indication for how long the event effects will last could also be helpful.
T4	Increase and maintain student satisfaction above 70% for 2 straight minutes.	0%	-	Difficult to maintain a large satisfaction.	1.0	There was a struggle to maintain a large satisfaction.
T5	Earn an achievement in the game.	100%	11.7 s	None	5.0	Add an indication to the list of all the achievements.
T6	Navigate through the game's interface and use all essential features (pause, place buildings, events etc).	100%	36.0 s	None	4.0	Interface design could be improved.

These results provide us with a list of goals to now work on to improve our final product.